

1. Say whether the following statement is true or false. Explain clearly your answer.

Let $f : \mathbb{R}^2 \rightarrow \mathbb{R}$ be a function with continuous partial derivatives up to order two. If a critical point (a, b) of the function f is such that

$$f_{xx}(a, b) > 0 \quad \text{and} \quad f_{xx}(a, b) + f_{yy}(a, b) = 0,$$

then the point (a, b) is a point of local minimum for the function f .

Using $f_{yy}(a, b) = -f_{xx}(a, b)$, we get that

$$\begin{aligned} D(a, b) &= f_{xx}(a, b)f_{yy}(a, b) - [f_{xy}(a, b)]^2 = -[f_{xx}(a, b)]^2 - [f_{xy}(a, b)]^2 \\ &= -\left([f_{xx}(a, b)]^2 + [f_{xy}(a, b)]^2\right) < 0 \quad (\text{Why can't we have } D(a, b) = 0 \text{ here!}). \end{aligned}$$

So, (a, b) is a saddle point and therefore, the statement is **false!**

2. Given the function $f(x, y) := xy + x - y$.

- (i) The only critical point is $(1, -1)$. The determinant of the hessian matrix is $-1 < 0$. Therefore $(1, -1)$ is a saddle point.
- (ii) Use Lagrange multipliers we find

$$\begin{aligned} y + 1 - 2\lambda x &= 0 \\ x - 1 - 2\lambda y &= 0 \quad (*) \\ x^2 + y^2 - 25 &= 0 \end{aligned}$$

First solution: from the first equation we get $y = 2\lambda x - 1$ that we substitute in the second equation and get $x(1 - 4\lambda^2) = 1 - 2\lambda$. Now, to solve this equation to find x , we need to check whether $1 - 4\lambda^2 \neq 0$ or $1 - 4\lambda^2 = 0$.

- (a) The case $1 - 4\lambda^2 = 0$, that is $\lambda = \pm \frac{1}{2}$: we get for $\lambda = -\frac{1}{2}$ that $0x = 2$ which is impossible. For $\lambda = \frac{1}{2}$ we get $0x = 0$ and we go back to the system $(*)$ which becomes

$$\begin{cases} y = x - 1, \\ x^2 + y^2 = 25 \end{cases} \Rightarrow x^2 + (x - 1)^2 = 25 \Leftrightarrow x^2 - x - 12 = 0 \quad x = -3, 4.$$

Thus, we find the points $\boxed{(-3, -4) \quad \text{and} \quad (4, 3)}$.

(b) The case $1 - 4\lambda^2 \neq 0$, that is, $\lambda \neq \pm \frac{1}{2}$. We find that

$$x = \frac{1 - 2\lambda}{1 - 4\lambda^2} = \frac{1 - 2\lambda}{(1 - 2\lambda)(1 + 2\lambda)} = \frac{1}{1 + 2\lambda}$$

and $y = -\frac{1}{1 + 2\lambda}$ which imply that $x = -y$. So, from the last equation in (*) we get

$$2x^2 = 25 \text{ that is, } x = \pm \frac{5}{\sqrt{2}}. \text{ Hence, we get the points } \left(\frac{5}{\sqrt{2}}, -\frac{5}{\sqrt{2}} \right) \text{ and } \left(-\frac{5}{\sqrt{2}}, \frac{5}{\sqrt{2}} \right).$$

Now, find the values of f at the points in (a) and (b); the smallest of these values is the minimum value of f on the circle $x^2 + y^2 = 25$ while the largest is the maximum.

Second solution: (from a student!) From the system

$$\begin{aligned} y + 1 - 2\lambda x &= 0 \\ x - 1 - 2\lambda y &= 0 \quad (*) \\ x^2 + y^2 - 25 &= 0 \end{aligned}$$

we add-up the first two equations to get

$$y + x - 2\lambda(x + y) = 0 \Leftrightarrow (1 - 2\lambda)(x + y) = 0 \Leftrightarrow 1 - 2\lambda = 0 \text{ or } x + y = 0.$$

Hence, we simply have the two cases $\lambda = \frac{1}{2}$ which gives the points $(-3, -4)$ and $(4, 3)$ as in the first solution and the case $y = -x$ from which we get the points $(\frac{5}{\sqrt{2}}, -\frac{5}{\sqrt{2}})$ and $(-\frac{5}{\sqrt{2}}, \frac{5}{\sqrt{2}})$ also as above.

Now, we evaluate the function f at those four points and decide which ones are points of maximum and which ones are points of minimum.

3. Find the points of absolute maximum and minimum of the function $f(x, y) := -x + y^2$ over the ellipse $E := \{(x, y) \in \mathbb{R}^2: x^2 + 4y^2 = 1\}$.

We use the method of Lagrange multipliers. We seek λ, x, y such that

$$\begin{cases} -1 - 2\lambda x = 0 \\ 2y - 8y\lambda = 0 \\ x^2 + 4y^2 = 1 \end{cases}$$

From the second equation we find $y = 0$ or $\lambda = \frac{1}{4}$.

For $y = 0$, we find from the third equation $x = \pm 1$ and from these values we can find the corresponding values of λ from the first equation. Hence, we get the points $(-1, 0)$ and $(1, 0)$.

For $\lambda = \frac{1}{4}$, we get from the first equation that $x = -2$ and from the third equation that $3 + 4y^2 = 0$ which is impossible. Therefore, we have two points $(-1, 0)$ and $(1, 0)$.

Since $f(-1, 0) = 1$ and $f(1, 0) = -1$, we get that $(-1, 0)$ is the point of absolute maximum while $(1, 0)$ is the point of absolute minimum.

4. Consider the function $f(x, y, z) = x + y + z$. Find the maximum and minimum values of f on the sphere $x^2 + y^2 + z^2 = 1$.

We set $g(x, y, z) = x^2 + y^2 + z^2 - 1$ and hence, we first find x, y, z, λ such that

$$\begin{cases} f_x(x, y, z) = \lambda g_x(x, y, z) \\ f_y(x, y, z) = \lambda g_y(x, y, z) \\ f_z(x, y, z) = \lambda g_z(x, y, z) \\ g(x, y, z) = 0 \end{cases} \Leftrightarrow \begin{cases} 1 = 2\lambda x \\ 1 = 2\lambda y \\ 1 = 2\lambda z \\ x^2 + y^2 + z^2 = 1. \end{cases}$$

From the first three equations, we find that $x = y = z = \frac{1}{2\lambda}$. Now substituting in the last equation, we get $\lambda = \pm \frac{\sqrt{3}}{2}$ and hence, the points $(-\frac{1}{\sqrt{3}}, -\frac{1}{\sqrt{3}}, -\frac{1}{\sqrt{3}})$ and $(\frac{1}{\sqrt{3}}, \frac{1}{\sqrt{3}}, \frac{1}{\sqrt{3}})$. $f(-\frac{1}{\sqrt{3}}, -\frac{1}{\sqrt{3}}, -\frac{1}{\sqrt{3}}) = -\sqrt{3}$ is the minimum while $f(\frac{1}{\sqrt{3}}, \frac{1}{\sqrt{3}}, \frac{1}{\sqrt{3}}) = \sqrt{3}$ is the maximum.

5. A box has to be constructed out of 120 cm² of material. Find the dimensions x, y and z of the box that maximize the volume.

We want to solve the problem $\begin{cases} \text{Maximize } V(x, y, z) = xyz \\ \text{subject to } 2xy + 2xz + 2yz = 120. \end{cases}$
where $2xy + 2xz + 2yz$ represents the total area of the 6 faces of the box.

(a) **First solution:** Using the method of the Lagrange multiplier, we set

$$A(x, y, z) := xy + xz + yz - 60$$

and we seek x, y, z, λ such that

$$\underbrace{\begin{cases} V_x(x, y, z) = \lambda A_x(x, y, z) \\ V_y(x, y, z) = \lambda A_y(x, y, z) \\ V_z(x, y, z) = \lambda A_z(x, y, z) \\ A(x, y, z) = 0, \end{cases}}_{(*)} \Leftrightarrow \underbrace{\begin{cases} yz = \lambda(y + z) \\ xz = \lambda(x + z), \\ xy = \lambda(x + y), \\ xy + xz + yz - 60 = 0, \end{cases}}_{(**)} \Leftrightarrow \underbrace{\begin{cases} xyz = \lambda x(y + z) \\ xyz = \lambda y(x + z), \\ xyz = \lambda z(x + y), \\ xy + xz + yz - 60 = 0, \end{cases}}_{(***)}$$

where you obtained the last system $(***)$ by multiplying the first three equations by x, y and z respectively in the system $(**)$. So, we get from the first three equations in $(***)$ that

$$\underbrace{\lambda x(y + z) = \lambda y(x + z) = \lambda z(x + y)}_{\lambda \neq 0} \Leftrightarrow x(y + z) = y(x + z) = z(x + y).$$

Thus we get

$$\begin{cases} x(y + z) = y(x + z) \\ y(x + z) = z(x + y) \end{cases} \Leftrightarrow \begin{cases} xz = yz \\ yx = zx \end{cases} \Leftrightarrow \boxed{x = y = z} \text{ (since } x > 0, y > 0, z > 0 \text{).}$$

So, if we substitute $x = y = z$ into the fourth equation in $(***)$, we get

$$3x^2 - 60 \Leftrightarrow x^2 = 20 \Leftrightarrow x = \sqrt{20} = y = z \Rightarrow \lambda = \frac{x^2}{2x} = \frac{20}{2\sqrt{20}} = \frac{\sqrt{20}}{2} = \sqrt{5}.$$

Hence, the dimensions x, y and z of the box that maximize the volume are $x = y = z = \sqrt{20}$. Notice that these dimensions can only realize the maximum since the minimum value here cannot be not achieved!

- (b) **Second solution:** Solve z from the constraint, solve $z = \frac{60 - xy}{x + y}$, substitute into the expression of V and get the function of two variables

$$f(x, y) = \frac{xy(60 - xy)}{x + y}$$

for which we find the maximum value in the set $\{(x, y): x > 0, y > 0, xy < 60\}$. Let us find the critical points of f .

$$\begin{cases} \frac{\partial f}{\partial x} = \frac{y^2(60 - x^2 - 2xy)}{(x + y)^2} = 0 \\ \frac{\partial f}{\partial y} = \frac{x^2(60 - y^2 - 2xy)}{(x + y)^2} = 0 \end{cases} \Rightarrow \begin{cases} 60 - x^2 - 2xy = 0 \\ 60 - y^2 - 2xy = 0 \end{cases}$$

Subtracting the two equations we get $x^2 - y^2 = 0$ which implies $x = y$. Substituting in the first equation above we obtain $60 - 3x^2 = 0$ which implies that $x = y = \sqrt{20}$. Hence, also $z = \sqrt{20}$. So, the box of maximum volume is a cube with size $\sqrt{20}$.

6. **(After Max/min-IV to be covered in the lecture on Friday)** Given the function $f(x, y) := xy + x - y$. Let $D := \{(x, y) \in \mathbb{R}^2: x^2 + y^2 \leq 25 \text{ and } x \geq 0\}$. Find the points of maximum and minimum of f on D .

Following the theory in the lecture notes Max/Min-IV, we split the problem into two: finding the points of maximum and minimum in the interior of the domain D and then on its boundary. The points of maximum and minimum in the interior are critical points of the function f .

- (i) We first find the critical points of f lying in the interior of the domain D . The only critical point is $(1, -1)$ which lies indeed in the interior of D . In fact,

$$1^2 + (-1)^2 = 2 < 25 \quad \text{and} \quad 1 > 0.$$

- (ii) Let us now find the maximum and minimum of f on the boundary of D . Now, the boundary of the domain D has two pieces: The right-half circle $x^2 + y^2 = 25$ with $x \geq 0$ and the segment line L on the y -axis joining the points $(0, -5)$ and $(0, 5)$.

Let us first find the points of maximum and minimum of the function f over the right-half circle through the method the Lagrange multiplier. So we seek x, y, λ such that

$$(*) \quad \begin{cases} y + 1 = 2\lambda x, \\ x - 1 = 2\lambda y, \\ x^2 + y^2 = 25, \quad x \geq 0. \end{cases}$$

So, we get from Question 2, the only points $(5/\sqrt{2}, -5/\sqrt{2})$ and $(4, 3)$ which correspond to $x \geq 0$.

- (ii) Now, we find the points of maximum and minimum of the function f over the segment line L which equivalent to finding the points of maximum and minimum of the function $f(0, y) = -y$ for $y \in [-5, 5]$. We get the points $(0, -5)$ and $(0, 5)$.

(iv) We find that

$$\begin{aligned}f(1, -1) &= 1; f(5/\sqrt{2}, -5/\sqrt{2}) = -\frac{25}{2} + \frac{5}{\sqrt{2}} + \frac{5}{\sqrt{2}} = -\frac{25}{2} + 5\sqrt{2} \approx -5,83. \\f(4, 3) &= 12 + 3 - 4 = 11, \quad f(0, -5) = 5, \quad f(0, 5) = -5.\end{aligned}$$

Hence, the function f has maximum value on D equal to 13 which is achieved at the point $(4, 3)$ and minimum value equal to $\frac{10\sqrt{2} - 25}{2}$ achieved at the point $(5/\sqrt{2}, -5/\sqrt{2})$.